

Sneha P.

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Academic Background

- **PhD Candidate, Berlin School of Economics** **Berlin, Germany**
Hertie School and ESMT Berlin *2021-Present*
Areas of research: Labour-force participation, Vocational training, Digitisation in education, School feeding programs, Climate
Policy Partners: GiZ, Rwandan TVET Board
Countries of research: India, Rwanda
Grants: Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (DFG) Grant 2026-27; Santander Wissenschaftsstipendium 2026; Collaborative Research Center TRR 190 2026; Joachim-Herz Stiftung Add On Fellowship 2025; German Institute for Development Evaluation (DEval) Grant 2023-2026; Bocconi University Laboratory for Effective Anti-poverty Policies (LEAP) Grant 2024; DAAD Doctoral Scholarship 2021-2023.
Research visits: Centre for Economic Performance, London School of Economics (2026).
Teaching: Teaching Assistant (to Prof. Arianna Ornaghi): Political Economy, Hertie School, 2022, 2023, 2026
Teaching Assistant (to Prof. Rajshri Jayaraman): Data Analytics, ESMT, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
Research Assistant (to Prof. Alexandra Spitz-Oener and Prof. Sulin Sardoschau): Humboldt University, 2022
- **MPhil Economics, University of Oxford** **Oxford, U.K.**
Department of Economics *2015-2017*
Thesis: Impact of a Vocational Training on Employment, Employability and other Socio-economic Indicators
Program Partner: Labournet, India
Grants: St. Edmund Hall, 50th Anniversary Grant 2016; St. Edmund Hall, Graduate College Grant 2016, 2017; J. N. Tata Trust Scholarship for Graduate Studies 2015; K. C. Mahindra Education Trust Scholarship for Graduate Studies 2015; Contemporary South Asian Studies travel grant.
- **PGD Applied Statistics, University of Mumbai** **Mumbai, India**
Department of Statistics *2014-2015*
Research project : Factors affecting the transmission of HIV from Parent to Child in Dharavi
Policy Partner: Mumbai District AIDS Control Society Award for academic performance (first percentile) 2014.
- **BA, Economics and Mathematics, University of Mumbai** **Mumbai, India**
Department of Economics and Mathematics *2012-2014*
Grants: Vimlabai Paritoshik grant; Sudha Joshi grant; Late Chandrashekar and Oak Prize for Performance in Mathematics; Kings College Summer School Scholarships 2013, 2014; Sir Dorabji Tata and J. R. D. Tata Scholarship 2011, Award for academic performance (first percentile) 2011, 2012, 2013.

Professional Experience

- **Senior Associate, Artha Global** **Mumbai, India**
Political Economy Think Tank *Feb 2020 to Aug 2021*
Lead research and engagements related to state capacity and governance. Research areas include;
 - Bureaucratic Reforms: Risk Aversion and Indecision among civil servants in India
 - Kerala COVID-19 Response: State capacity and public health systems
 - Evaluation of Indian central pandemic relief package (Funded by World Bank)
 - Methodological and ethical evaluation of RCTs for policy
 - Data governance: Patient privacy, regulation of algorithms etc.
- **Economist, Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs** **Monrovia, Liberia**
Overseas Development Institute Fellowship *Oct 2017 to Dec 2019*
Assessing loan proposals, Analysing historic and expected public debt, Monitoring national macroeconomic indicators for Department of Economic Management. Projects include;
 - Developing Public Debt Data Dashboard
 - Data Analysis for Civil Service Wage Reform
 - Conducting training and workshops on excel dashboards

- **Economist, Ministry of Finance and Development Planning** **Banjul, The Gambia**
Overseas Development Institute Fellowship *Oct 2017 to Dec 2019*
 Policy Implementation Review, Data Analysis, Research and Capacity Building for the Directorate of Economic Policy and Research, Department of Macroeconomic Policy Analysis (DMPA). Projects include;

 - Developing Department Working Paper Series (Corporate Taxation, Social Protection Budgeting)
 - Establishing and Managing Macro-fiscal Database
 - Data Analysis for Macroeconomic Reports
- **Consultant, Sattva** **Delhi, Mumbai, India**
Development Research and Consulting firm *Jan to Apr 2019; Aug to Sep 2017*

 - Team lead on a meta-analysis of data and research on falling female-labour force participation in India as part of the Disha Project, UNDP India. Presented findings to Ministry of Skill Development and Niti Aayog (Planning Commission)(Funded by UNDP).
 - Mixed-Methods Assessment of NGO Yuva Parivarthan's Livelihood Development Programs (Centre-based, Out-reach, Online Job-exchange) in Maharashtra (Funded by J. P. Morgan).
- **Short term Consultant, Oxford Policy Management(OPM)** **Oxford, U.K.**
Decision Support Unit *Jul to Aug 2017*
 Providing Assessments on Data Quality and Reporting of Baseline and Mid-line Evaluations of 13 Private Sector Development Programs implemented in the Democratic Republic of Congo(DRC) (Funded by the UK Department for International Development)
- **Co-founder, Researcher, [InsightsApplied](#)** **Pan-India**
Policy and Development Research *2012 - 2021*

 - Impact Evaluation and Development of MNE systems for a Livelihoods Social Enterprise Labournet (funded by Mahindra and Mahindra).
 - Assessment of Vocational Training programs for Construction workers (for Godrej Properties).
 - Sector report on pro-poor financially sustainable Health Care systems (for Acumen Trust).
 - Evaluation of a SDET NGO's educational institutions in Tamil Nadu (for TVS Motors).
 - Mapping Asset Creation under National Rural Employment Guarantee for Tamil Nadu Department for Rural Development.
 - White paper on the Political Empowerment of Women through SHG groups for Tamil Nadu Department for Cooperation for Development of Women (TNCDW).
 - Editing Tamil Nadu State Rural Livelihood Mission Implementation Plan for TNCDW.
 - Report on Electricity Sector Governance for Tamil Nadu Electricity Board.
 - Study of Bee-Keeping as Social Entrepreneurship, Gujarat.
- **Jr. Consultant, Institute for Financial Management and Research** **Chennai, India**
Centre of Development Finance *Sep - Oct 2011; Feb - Apr 2012*

 - Citizen Charters of State policies for the Tamil Nadu Department for Rural Development.
 - Study on the adoption behaviour of improved cook stoves.
 - White paper on Renewable Energy Policies in India.
 - Creating a comprehensive database of social enterprises in India.

Articles and Publications

- **Working Papers and selected work in progress**

 - Job search and career considerations among job market entrants in urban India ([Pre-registration](#))
 - Hazardous environment and labour market outcomes in India.
 - [The Impact of In-law Mortality on Women's Labor Supply in India](#) (with Raji Jayaraman)
 - Long-term effects of school feeding programs on the labour market (with Tanika Chakraborty and Raji Jayaraman).
 - The trade off between social norms and flexibility in the labour supply of married women in India ([Pre-registration](#)) (with Vincent Ramos and Anirudh Tagat).
 - Explaining recent trends in Indian female labour-force participation (with Marianne Bertrand and Raji Jayaraman).
 - Evaluation of digital skills training for vocational education teachers in Rwanda ([Pre-registration](#)) (with Sunna Hügemann and Raji Jayaraman)

- Effect of motivational nudges on teachers’ online professional development in Rwanda (**Pre-registration**) (with Sunna Hügemann and Raji Jayaraman)
- **Peer-reviewed Publications**
 - **RCTs for Policy: Ethical and Methodological Concerns**, *Indian Public Policy Review* 2021
 - **Bureaucratic Risk Aversion and Indecision in India**, *Indian Public Policy Review* 2021
 - **Aadhaar-Based Biometrics and Food Security**, *Indian Journal of Human Development*, 2018
- **Policy Papers and reports**
 - **COVID-19 Pandemic in Kerala - A State Capacity Perspective**, *IDFC Institute* 2020
 - **PM Garib Kalyan Yojana: Coverage, Identification and Implementation**, *IDFC Institute* 2020
 - **Female work and Labour force participation in India** (Report), *UNDP India*, 2019
 - **Social Protection Financing in The Gambia**, *Ministry of Finance Working Papers*, 2018
 - **Corporate Taxation in The Gambia**, *Ministry of Finance Working Papers*, 2018
- **Articles/OpEds**
 - **RCTs for policymaking**, *Ideas for India*, 2020
 - **Do COVID-19 Patients have a right to Privacy?**, *The Wire*, 2020
 - **Women and work: Examining India’s policy landscape**, *Indian Development Review*, 2019
 - **Women’s workforce participation: What We Need to Know**, *Indian Development Review*, 2019
 - **Social Norms keeping Indian women out of Labour Market**, *FirstPost*, 2019
 - **Book review: Dreamers: How Young Indians Are Changing the World**, *Indian Journal of Human Development*, 2018
 - **Not Everything that can be Counted**, *Economic Political Weekly*, 2017
 - **Nudging India forward: Setting up a Nudge Unit**, *Livemint*, 2016
- **Multi-media**
 - **Data Governance during COVID-19**, *IDFC Institute*, 2020
 - **Interpreting Kerala’s COVID-19 Numbers**, *EPW* 2020
 - **Comicky Evaluation**, *Dharavi Biennale* 2015

Other

Languages: English (native), Hindi (fluent), Malayalam (fluent), German (B1) and French (A2).

Software: R, Excel, STATA, Dynare(MATLAB) and L^AT_EX

References: Available on request